

Manuscript

Opening Confession

True! nervous—very, very dreadfully nervous I had been and am; but why will you say that I am mad?

Object there was none. Passion there was none. I loved the old man. He had never wronged me.

I think it was his eye! One of his eyes resembled that of a vulture—a pale blue eye, with a film over it.

The Murder

For seven long nights I went to the old man's chamber at midnight, turning the latch so gently that no sound would wake him.

On the eighth night, the eye was open, and I heard the old man's terror before I heard his heart.

It grew louder—louder—louder—until I dragged him to the floor and pulled the heavy bed over him.

Police Arrival

A shriek in the night had brought three officers to my door before dawn.

I smiled and welcomed them, set chairs above the very planks where I had hidden the body, and spoke with perfect composure.

But the ringing in my ears returned as a beating underfoot, and at last I cried out for them to tear up the boards.

Live Test

This chapter was added while TRURL is running.